

BASSEL AL [REDACTED]

Senior Middleware & Integration Engineer | Technical Lead

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Professional Summary

Senior Middleware and Integration Engineer with 8+ years of experience architecting, developing, and leading enterprise-grade API ecosystems for banking and fintech institutions across the MENA region and Europe. Deep specialist in Oracle SOA/OSB, REST/SOAP API design, BPEL orchestration, and ETL pipelines, with a consistent record of delivering seamless integrations between core banking systems, mobile platforms, card management, KYC workflows, and government services.

Operates at the intersection of engineering and leadership: gathering client requirements, owning API documentation and integration strategy, mentoring 10+ junior developers, and driving Agile ceremonies from stand-ups to retrospectives. Experienced in CI/CD pipeline processes, feature flag-based rollouts, and load testing with SoapUI. Equally effective as a hands-on senior engineer and as a technical lead, a combination that reduces delivery risk and accelerates team output in complex, high-stakes integration environments.

Core Competencies

- **Integration & APIs:** Middleware Architecture (SOA, OSB, BPEL, WebLogic), REST/SOAP API Design, API Documentation & Integration Strategy
- **Banking Domain:** Core Banking, Mobile Banking, Card Management, KYC, Open Banking APIs and Government Services Integrations
- **Leadership & Delivery:** Team Coaching & Mentorship (10+ Developers), Requirements Gathering, Client-Facing Technical Liaison and End-to-End API Delivery
- **Agile & Process:** Agile/Scrum Facilitation, Sprint Planning, Stand-ups, Retrospectives, Feature Demos and Stakeholder Alignment
- **Quality & Testing:** UAT, Smoke & Regression Testing, Load Testing (SoapUI), Feature Flag Rollouts and CI/CD Pipeline Contribution
- **Engineering:** ETL Pipeline Design (IBM DataStage), C#/.NET Web Development, Mobile App Publishing (iOS & Android)

Experience

Infostructure

Senior Software Developer | Lebanon | November 2023 – Present

- Architect and deliver enterprise REST and SOAP APIs using Oracle SOA Suite, OSB 12c, and WebLogic, enabling seamless integration between core banking systems and third-party platforms across card management, fund transfers, KYC, and customer information workflows.
- Act as technical liaison between business stakeholders and engineering teams: gathering and translating client requirements into sprint-ready items, defining API contracts, and producing end-to-end API documentation for consumer teams.
- Deliver production integrations for high-profile clients including Bank Audi, Neo Bank, Insys, Case Manager, and Areeba, operating across domains including card management, transfer APIs, customer information, and KYC.
- Develop and maintain dynamic web applications using C# / ASP.NET MVC, HTML5/CSS3, and JavaScript (jQuery), built on the .NET 4.7 framework for both internal tooling and client-facing portals.

- Apply JDBC with design patterns and write optimized SQL and PL/SQL stored procedures to support data access layers and backend processing within integration workflows.
- Coach and mentor SOA and OSB developers on best practices, integration design patterns, and day-to-day development challenges, improving team capability and delivery consistency.
- Execute smoke, regression, and user acceptance testing (UAT) across each release cycle; support feature flag-based rollouts and contribute to CI/CD pipeline processes to ensure production stability.
- Facilitate Agile Scrum ceremonies including sprint planning, daily stand-ups, feature demos, and retrospectives, maintaining team velocity and stakeholder alignment.

Datamine

Freelance Middleware Coach & Consultant | Lebanon | January 2024 – Present

- Coach and mentor 10+ junior developers on Oracle SOA and OSB architecture, accelerating technical onboarding and proficiency across middleware development workflows.
- Advise on enterprise integration design patterns, API lifecycle management, scalable middleware architecture, and service governance best practices.
- Support the company in designing and implementing complex API integrations across enterprise systems, acting as an external technical resource on high-complexity projects.

SGBL Bank (Société Générale de Banque au Liban)

Senior Software Lead / Senior Developer | Lebanon | October 2017 – November 2023

Leadership Phase (Jan 2023 – Nov 2023):

- Promoted to lead the middleware development team: assigned tasks with accurate man-day estimations, conducted code reviews, enforced development standards, and coached SOA and OSB developers through day-to-day technical challenges.
- Led Agile ceremonies including sprint planning, daily stand-ups, and retrospectives; delivered internal feature demos to stakeholders and maintained full delivery alignment throughout each sprint cycle.
- Maintained hands-on development across C# / ASP.NET MVC, HTML5/CSS3, and JavaScript (jQuery) on the .NET 4.7 framework, while writing database queries to support feature development and debugging.

Senior Developer Phase (Jan 2020 – Dec 2022):

- Architected and delivered REST and SOAP API integrations for SGBL's international subsidiaries SGBJ (Jordan) and SGBCY (Cyprus), covering mobile app services, card management, user management, and open banking solutions for European market compliance.
- Engineered the Madfouaat.com integration: built APIs consuming Jordanian government services for real-time customer data retrieval, complete with full consumer-facing API documentation.
- Designed and developed OSB services using Web Services, Java, SOAP, REST, XQuery, WSDL, and XSD; created user-defined functions in Java compiled as external JAR files for use within BPEL orchestration processes.
- Developed and maintained internal APIs connecting SGBL's mobile banking application to the core banking system, delivering new features, API modifications, and continuous legacy API maintenance.
- Resolved front-end bugs and regressions on the Backbase CXP 5.0 platform; performed smoke, regression, and UAT testing; developed SoapUI scripts for load testing of OSB and SOA services.
- Designed and developed IBM DataStage ETL pipelines for data loading, cleansing, and transformation from Oracle, SQL Server, and flat-file sources into the enterprise data warehouse, applying complex business rules for data validation and messaging.
- Managed end-to-end mobile app publishing: received APK/IPA builds and deployed to Google Play and App Store for both test and production environments.

Junior Developer Phase (Oct 2017 – Dec 2019):

- Contributed to full-stack development using Angular (frontend) and Groovy scripts (backend), supporting web application features and backend data processing workflows.
- Performed Android and iOS mobile app bug fixing; migrated legacy business data from Excel into structured Oracle database tables using custom backend scripts.
- Gained foundational hands-on experience in OSB service design, SOAP/REST API development, JDBC integrations, and SQL stored procedures, building the technical base for subsequent specialization in enterprise middleware engineering.

Education

American University of Science and Technology (AUST)

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science | Zahle, Lebanon | 2013 – 2017

Certifications

- First Computer Science Project | American University of Science and Technology | 2017
- CCNA Routing and Switching: Routing and Switching Essentials | Cisco Networking Academy | 2017
- CCNA Routing and Switching: Introduction to Networks | Cisco Networking Academy | 2016

Technical Skills

- **Middleware & Integration:** Oracle SOA Suite, Oracle Service Bus (OSB) 12c, Oracle ADF, BPEL, Apache Camel, IBM DataStage ETL, WebLogic, JMS/MQ
- **API & Web Services:** REST, SOAP, WSDL, XSD, XQuery, XML, JSON, Postman, SoapUI (load & regression testing)
- **Languages:** Java (incl. user-defined functions / external JAR files for BPEL), C#, Groovy, JavaScript (jQuery), Angular, SQL, PL/SQL, HTML5, CSS3, Bootstrap
- **Frameworks:** ASP.NET MVC (.NET 4.7), Spring Boot, Backbase CXP 5.x
- **Databases:** Oracle 12c, SQL Server, PL/SQL Stored Procedures, JDBC
- **DevOps & Tools:** Git (GitHub / GitLab), SVN, JIRA, IntelliJ IDEA, JDeveloper, Visual Studio, Android Studio, Xcode
- **CI/CD & Release:** CI/CD Pipelines (contribution & integration), Feature Flag-Based Rollouts, Pre-Release Validation
- **Mobile Deployment:** Android and iOS App Publishing: Google Play Store and Apple App Store
- **Methodologies:** Agile / Scrum, Sprint Planning, Retrospectives, Code Review, Man-day Estimation

Languages

Arabic (Native) English (Fluent) French (Intermediate)